

FILM DOSSIER: THOR: STORMBREAKER

Phase 2 · Film #2 (Saga Film #10)

Status:  DOSSIER COMPLETE (awaiting showrunner lock)

1. IDENTITY

Field	Entry
Film #	10 of 29 (Phase 2, Film #2)
Phase	Phase 2
Real title	<i>THOR: STORMBREAKER</i>
Decoy / codename title	<i>"HORSE COUNTRY"</i>
Release date	Friday, July 26, 2013
Distributor	Walt Disney Studios Motion Pictures
Director	Kenneth Branagh
Rating / runtime	PG-13 · 160 minutes
Genre + second genre	Superhero action-adventure + cosmic Norse saga / space opera

2. OWNERSHIP

Field	Entry
Whose film / franchise is this?	ESTHER SMILLEY (Thor, film 2 of the franchise)

Character	Actor	Age at release
Thor / Dr. Donna Blake	Esther Smalley	30
Beta Ray Bill (<i>on-set performance capture and prosthetics</i>)	Terry Crews (<i>fresh casting: never played by a real actor</i>)	44
Malekith the Accursed	Christopher Eccleston	49
Algrim the Strong / Kurse	Adewale Akinnuoye-Agbaje	45
Odin	Anthony Hopkins	75
Frigga	Rene Russo	59
Jane Foster	Natalie Portman	32
Heimdall	Idris Elba	40
Sif	Jaimie Alexander	29
Volstagg / Fandral / Hogun	Ray Stevenson / Zachary Levi / Tadanobu Asano	49 / 32 / 39
Loki	Tom Hiddleston	32
Nick Fury	Samuel L. Jackson	64
Taneleer Tivan, the Collector (<i>post-credit</i>)	Benicio del Toro	46
Thanos (<i>post-credit, voice only</i>)	Josh Brolin	45
The Wasp / Giant-Man (<i>cameo, frozen Manhattan</i>)	Elxa Bullock / Tyler Chapman	32 / 31
Tony Stark (<i>cameo, tracking Bill's ship</i>)	Marc-Anthony Bullock	31
Stan Lee (<i>cameo: a New Yorker shoveling snow in July</i>)	Stan Lee	90

3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

Field	Entry
Primary comic(s) adapted	Walter Simonson's <i>Thor</i> , the definitive run: <i>Thor</i> #337–340 (1983–84), the coming of Beta Ray Bill , who lifts Mjolnir , and the forging of Stormbreaker ; <i>Thor</i> #344–349 (1984), Malekith the Accursed , the Casket of Ancient Winters , and Algrim/Kurse .
Supporting comics	<i>Thor</i> #340–353 (Simonson, Surtur and the Twilight Sword, which is seeded here and pays off in Phase 3) · <i>The Thanos Quest</i> #1–2 (1990, Jim Starlin): Thanos takes the Gems from the Elders of the Universe , including the Collector
Nerf check	✅ Beta Ray Bill beats Thor because of the 60-second rule (she's separated from Mjolnir and turns back into Blake), exactly as in <i>Thor</i> #337. He then proves himself worthy . Neither of them is written weaker.

3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

Field	Entry
Overall accuracy score	97%. Simonson's first year, adapted in order.

Straight from the page:

- **S.H.I.E.L.D.** detects an unknown starship heading for Earth, and **Nick Fury** calls in Thor (*Thor* #337).
- **Beta Ray Bill**, champion of the **Korbinites**, a race whose home galaxy was destroyed by **Surtur's demons**, fights Thor. When Thor is **separated from Mjolnir for sixty seconds**, she **turns back into Blake**. Bill picks up the cane, strikes it, and **gets the power of Thor** (#337).
- **Odin summons "Thor" to Asgard** and **Bill arrives**. Odin orders a **trial by combat** on the fiery world of **Skartheim**. **Bill wins** (#338–339).
- Bill **refuses to keep a weapon he didn't earn**. Odin has the dwarves **forge Stormbreaker** for Bill, with the same enchantment as Mjolnir (#339–340).
- **Malekith the Accursed**, lord of the **Dark Elves**, steals the **Casket of Ancient Winters**. Opened on Earth, it would bring **endless winter** (#344–349).
- **Algrim the Strong** is betrayed by Malekith and **turned into Kurse**, a nearly unstoppable warrior sworn to revenge (#347–349).
- **Surtur is the power behind all of it** (#340 on). He's seeded here.

Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

|---|---|

| Beta Ray Bill and Malekith (1983–84) in one film | Simonson's first year, told as one film |

| Thor's opponent in the 60-second fight is female | Thor has always been female in our universe. The fight is otherwise the same. |

| The Blake identity continues (on 616 it ended during Simonson's run) | It's held until the Phase 3 Thor film for story reasons |

POWERS & ABILITIES

Character	616 powers & abilities	Shown in this film	Held back (why)	Match
Thor	God-level strength; Mjolnir's full powers	Breaks open a Dark Elf fortress; calls down a thunderstorm over the Arctic	God Blast, Odinfence	✓ 100%
Beta Ray Bill	Korbinite cyborg: class-100 strength , extreme durability, survives in space; worthy of Mjolnir ; wields Stormbreaker : flight, lightning, weather, a hammer that returns (<i>Thor</i> #337)	All of it: he trades blows with Thor evenly, lifts Mjolnir , and wins the trial by combat on Skarheim	His warship Skuttlebutt (shown), and his full history (Phase 3)	✓ 100%
Malekith	Dark Elf sorcerer: teleportation, illusions, shape-shifting, ice and darkness magic (<i>Thor</i> #344)	All of it; he impersonates Odin	—	✓ 100%
Kurse	Enormous strength and durability (stood up to Thor and Bill together); armor; driven by revenge (#347)	Takes on Thor and Beta Ray Bill at the same time	—	✓ 100%
The Casket of Ancient Winters	Brings endless winter	Manhattan freezes in July	—	✓ 100%
Odin	The Odinfence	Presides over the trial; restores Algrim's mind	Full power (a saga-level moment)	✓ 100%
The Collector	An Elder of the Universe : immortal, the galaxy's greatest collector	The post-credit scene	—	✓ 100%

4. STORY

Field	Entry
Logline	A stranger with a horse's face and a hero's heart lifts Thor's hammer, and to save both their worlds from the Dark Elves' eternal winter, the god of thunder has to share the storm.
Theme	Worthiness isn't one person's property. Anyone can be worthy, even a monster.
Villain / antagonist	Malekith the Accursed (main); Kurse (tragic); Surtur (behind it all)

What the movie is about

ACT ONE: THE STRANGER

- **Monday, May 20, 2013.** **Nick Fury** reaches Thor, now an Avenger, about an **unknown warship** crossing the orbit of Mars.
- Thor boards it. Its pilot, a towering, horse-faced cyborg named **Beta Ray Bill**, fights back. In the fight, Mjolnir is knocked away and **sixty seconds pass**. Thor turns back into **Dr. Blake** in the middle of the battle.
- Bill picks up the cane, **strikes it**, and **becomes a Thor**.

ACT TWO: THE TRIAL

- Odin summons "Thor" home, and **Bill arrives**. Asgard is stunned.
- Bill explains that his people, the **Korbinites**, are the last survivors of a galaxy **burned by the demons of Surtur**. He needs Mjolnir to save them.
- Odin orders a **trial by combat** on **Skartheim**, a world of fire. It's **Thor against Bill**, and **Bill wins**.
- Bill **refuses to take the hammer from her**. Odin, moved, has the dwarves forge **Stormbreaker**. Bill has his own hammer now, and Thor has a brother-in-arms.

ACT THREE: THE CASKET OF ANCIENT WINTERS

- **Malekith the Accursed** steals the **Casket of Ancient Winters** from Odin's vault and sacrifices his lieutenant **Algrim**, who is reborn as the monster **Kurse**.
 - He takes the Casket to **Earth** and opens it over **Manhattan**, and **New York freezes in July**.
 - **Thor and Beta Ray Bill** fight side by side through a frozen city, Mjolnir and Stormbreaker, two thunderstorms against the cold.
 - **Kurse** is freed from Malekith's control, **turns on his master**, and takes Malekith with him into the void.
 - Thor seals the Casket. The ice melts.
 - Bill heads back to the Korbinites with Stormbreaker. At the Bifrost, Thor clasps his arm: *"Brother."*
 - Thor and **Jane** sit on a Manhattan rooftop in the thaw, their first real vacation.
 - Odin, alone, looks into the fire: **Surtur is awake**.
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5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

Field	Entry
When it's set	Monday, May 20, 2013 → Saturday, June 29, 2013. The post-credit scene is undated (somewhere in deep space).
Where it's set	Mars orbit · Asgard · Skartheim · Svartalfheim (the Dark Elf realm) · New York City (a frozen Manhattan, filmed with practical snow on location)
Relative to other films	Six weeks after <i>Iron Man 3</i>. Tony helps S.H.I.E.L.D. track Bill's ship by satellite, through Extremis, in one scene.

6. WORLD-BUILDING

The film's own world

- **Beta Ray Bill, Stormbreaker,** and the **Korbinites.**
- **The Dark Elves** and **Malekith.**
- **Surtur**, the fire giant stirring in Muspelheim.
- **Worthiness** is now **a rule of the universe**, not just a family matter.

World-building for the wider MCU

Seed	How it appears	Payoff
The cosmos is crowded	Bill's backstory: whole galaxies destroyed	Phase 2 cosmic films
Surtur	Odin looking into the fire	The Phase 3 Thor film (Simonson's Surtur saga)
The Avengers on call	A frozen Manhattan: the Wasp flies rescue runs and Giant-Man clears the ice from the Brooklyn Bridge in a cameo	<i>Avengers 2</i>
Loki	Loki, still exiled, watches the Casket open and laughs. He tells Thor: <i>"You'll need more than a horse to stop what's coming."</i>	The next film Loki appears in

Setting up the Big Bad

Seed	How it appears	What it means
"The Infinity Gems"	Odin tells Thor about the Elders of the Universe and the six Infinity Gems . This is the first time the name is said in the MCU.	The Gems now have a name.
The Thanos Quest on screen	The post-credit scene	Thanos takes his first Gem.

7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

Field	Entry
Mid-credit scene	✓ "SKUTTLEBUTT." Bill's warship crosses the dark between galaxies. On the bridge, Bill turns Stormbreaker over in his hands. The ship's AI speaks: <i>"Course set for the Burning Galaxy, Bill."</i> Bill: <i>"Then let's go home."</i>
Post-credit scene	✓ "THE COLLECTOR." The Collector's museum, a vast vault of alien specimens on a distant world. Every display case is shattered. The Collector, Taneleer Tivan , an Elder of the Universe, crawls across the floor to an empty jewel setting . Behind him, a golden gauntlet catches the light. One of its six settings is no longer empty. THANOS (off-screen): <i>"Keep your curiosities, Elder. I only came for the one."</i> CUT TO BLACK. "THOR WILL RETURN."
Secret shoot codenames	Mid-credit: "ROAD TRIP II." Post-credit: "GARAGE SALE."

CHECKLIST

- [x] Comic(s) adapted · [x] Comic Accuracy Report + powers · [x] Real and decoy titles · [x] What it's about · [x] Villain · [x] Post-credit scenes · [x] The film's own world-building · [x] MCU world-building · [x] Big Bad setup · [x] Whose franchise · [x] When and where in the timeline